



The Richest Man in History: Mansa Musa's Golden Legacy

【TED科普：史上最富有的人是谁？】

Summary: If someone asked you who the richest people in history were, you might name modern billionaires like Bill Gates. However, 14th-century African king Mansa Musa of the Mali Empire possibly amassed one of the largest fortunes ever. His wealth was showcased during his extravagant pilgrimage to Mecca in 1324, where his spending of gold reportedly caused regional inflation. Beyond material riches, Mansa Musa expanded his empire, controlled key trade routes, and promoted education and Islam. He built mosques and universities, making Timbuktu a center of learning. His legacy endures through historical sites and medieval maps that cemented his legendary status.

摘要：如果有人问起历史上最富有的人，你可能会提到现代亿万富翁如比尔·盖茨。但14世纪马里帝国的非洲国王曼萨·穆萨，可能积累了史上最庞大的财富之一。1324年，他在麦加朝圣期间大肆挥霍黄金，据传导致地区通货膨胀。除了物质财富，曼萨·穆萨扩张了帝国版图，控制了重要贸易路线，并推动教育和伊斯兰文化发展。他建造清真寺和大学，使廷巴克图成为学术中心。他的遗产通过历史遗迹和中世纪地图得以延续，巩固了其传奇地位。





🕒 Estimated Reading Time: 5 min.

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▶ If someone asked you who the richest people in history were, who would you name?

如果有人问你史上最富有的人是谁，你会说出哪些名字？

▶ Perhaps a billionaire banker or corporate mogul, like Bill Gates or John D. Rockefeller.

或许是某位亿万富翁#银行家#或企业大亨，比如比尔·盖茨或约翰·D·洛克菲勒。

▶ How about African King Musa Keita I?

那么非洲的穆萨·凯塔一世国王呢？

▶ Ruling the Mali Empire in the 14th century CE, Mansa Musa, or the King of Kings, amassed a fortune that possibly made him one of the wealthiest people who ever lived.

曼萨·穆萨——意为“万王之王”，于公元14世纪统治马里帝国时积累财富，可能使他成为有史以来最富有的人之一。

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▶ But his vast wealth was only one piece of his rich legacy.

但他巨大的财富只是其丰厚#遗产#的一部分。

▶ When Mansa Musa came to power in 1312, much of Europe was racked by famine and civil wars.

当曼萨·穆萨于1312年掌权时，欧洲大部分地区正遭受#饥荒#和内战的折磨。

▶ But many African kingdoms and the Islamic world were flourishing, and Mansa Musa played a great role in bringing the fruits of this flourishing to his own realm.

但许多非洲王国和伊斯兰世界正蓬勃发展，曼萨·穆萨在将这种繁荣成果引入自己的王国方面发挥了重要作用。

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▶ By strategically annexing the city of Timbuktu, and reestablishing power over the city of Gao, he gained control over important trade routes between the Mediterranean and the West African Coast, continuing a period of expansion, which dramatically increased Mali's size.

通过战略吞并廷巴克图城并重掌加奥城控制权，他掌控了地中海与西非海岸间的重要贸易路线，延续了帝国的扩张期，大幅增加了马里的疆域。

▶ The territory of the Mali Empire was rich in natural resources, such as gold and salt.

马里帝国的领土富含黄金和盐等自然资源。

▶ The world first witnessed the extent of Mansa Musa's wealth in 1324 when he took his pilgrimage to Mecca.

1324年曼萨·穆萨前往#麦加#朝圣时，世界首次目睹其财富规模。

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▶ Not one to travel on a budget, he brought a caravan stretching as far as the eye could see.

他的朝圣之旅极尽奢华，随行驼队延绵至天际。

▶ Accounts of this journey are mostly based on an oral testimony and differing written records, so it's difficult to determine the exact details.

关于这段旅程的记载多基于#口头##证词#和不同文字记录，因此难以确定具体细节。

▶ But what most agree on is the extravagant scale of the excursion.

但人们普遍认同的是这次#远行#的#奢华#规模。

▶ Chroniclers describe an entourage of tens of thousands of soldiers, civilians, and slaves, 500 heralds bearing gold staffs and dressed in fine silks, and many camels and horses bearing an abundance of gold bars.

编年史家记载其随行人员包括数万士兵、平民和奴隶，500名手持金杖、身着丝绸的传令官，以及驮着大量金块的骆驼与马匹。

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▶ Stopping in cities such as Cairo, Mansa Musa is said to have spent massive quantities of gold, giving to the poor, buying souvenirs, and even having mosques built along the way.

据传曼萨·穆萨在开罗等城市停留时挥霍大量黄金：施舍穷人、购买纪念品，甚至沿途修建清真寺。

▶ In fact, his spending may have destabilized the regional economy, causing mass inflation.

事实上他的挥霍可能动摇了地区经济稳定，引发大规模#通货膨胀#。

▶ This journey reportedly took over a year, and by the time Mansa Musa returned, tales of his amazing wealth had spread to the ports of the Mediterranean.

据称这次旅程耗时逾一年，待曼萨·穆萨归来时，其惊人财富的故事已传遍地中海各港口。

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▶ Mali and its king were elevated to near legendary status, cemented by their inclusion on the 1375 Catalan Atlas.

马里及其国王被提升至近乎#传奇#的地位，1375年《加泰罗尼亚#地图集#》的收录更是巩固了这一声誉。

▶ One of the most important world maps of Medieval Europe, it depicted the King holding a scepter and a gleaming gold nugget.

作为#中世纪#欧洲最重要的世界地图之一，图中描绘这位国王手持权杖与闪耀的金块。

▶ Mansa Musa had literally put his empire and himself on the map.

曼萨·穆萨真正让他的帝国与自己名留青史。

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▶ But material riches weren't the king's only concern.

但物质财富并非这位国王唯一关心之事。

▶ As a devout Muslim, he took a particular interest in Timbuktu, already a center of religion and learning prior to its annexation.

作为#虔诚#的穆斯林，他对吞并前已是宗教与学术中心的廷巴克图格外重视。

▶ Upon returning from his pilgrimage, he had the great Djinguereber Mosque built there with the help of an Andalusian architect.

朝圣归来后，他在安达卢西亚#建筑师#协助下建造了宏伟的金格雷贝尔#清真寺#。

▶ He also established a major university, further elevating the city's reputation, and attracting scholars and students from all over the Islamic world.

他还创建了一所重要学府，进一步提升城市声誉，吸引来自伊斯兰世界各地的学者与学生。

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▶ Under Mansa Musa, the Empire became urbanized, with schools and mosques in hundreds of densely populated towns.

在曼萨·穆萨统治下，帝国实现城镇化，数百个人口稠密的城镇涌现出学校与清真寺。

▶ The king's rich legacy persisted for generations and to this day, there are mausoleums, libraries and mosques that stand as a testament to this golden age of Mali's history.

国王的丰厚遗产延续数代，至今仍存留的陵墓、图书馆和清真寺，见证着马里历史的这段黄金时代。

